

Repeat listening is growth's hidden ceiling at Spotify

- 629 public feedback posts analyzed | 100% themed

- Growth

Millions of users still listen from comfort playlists, not discovery

- Spotify has world-class recommendations - yet repeat playlists dominate listening

- Strateg

We analyzed 629 public feedback posts across 4 channels

- Google Play (87%) | Reddit | Community forums | Social media

- Pipeline

Users repeat because decision fatigue beats risky exploration

- 1. Hard to find new music: 48.6% (306 posts)

- 2. Free

Interviews confirmed AI themes - and revealed one surprise

- n=6 segment-fit interviews (Indian urban 22-35, playlist-heavy listeners)

- Validate

The real problem: transition-moment decision fatigue

- Segment defaults to 2-3 comfort playlists when mental energy is low

- Root ca

Traditional recommendation optimizes familiarity, not intentional discovery

- Collaborative filtering reinforces taste clusters -> comfort loops

- Discover

LoopBreak explains why you're stuck - then offers 3 discovery paths

- AI-native MVP: diagnosis + 3 strategies (mood / social / forgotten saves)

- Ground

AI changes UX from passive feed to guided discovery with agency

- Before: open app -> same playlist -> passive play

- After: d

Success metrics: discovery sessions, new artists, D7 retention

- Primary: discovery session rate (% sessions with play outside top 3 playlists)
- Second